INCH-POUND

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5 December 1990
SUPERSEDING
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MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BLUEBERRY DESSERT, TRAY PACK

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers blueberry dessert in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-636 = Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be used in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8940

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MILITARY

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For
MIL-C-44340 - Can, Tray Pack

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-900 - Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks and Sugars Used in the Preparation of Thermostabilized Foods for the Armed Forces

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

* 2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Copies are available from the Office of Drinking Water, Environmental Protection Agency, WH550D, 401 M Street, S.W., Washington, DC 20460.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Copies are available from the Chairman, Condition of Container Committee, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2506, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

U.S. Standards for Grades of Blueberries for Processing

(Copies are available from the Director, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2077, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

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U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES (HHS)

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3330 - Peel Adhesion of Pressure-Sensitive Tape

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 2200 Wilson Boulevard, Suite 400-CD, Arlington, VA 22201-3301.)

NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCES

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

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2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.1), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.2) in accordance with 4.4.

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

* 3.2.1 Blueberries, fresh. The fresh blueberries shall be U.S. Number 2 or better of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Blueberries for Processing. The blueberries shall be of the native or wild type (Maine lowbush), Vaccinium angustifolium) or may be a cultivated type suitable for canning. The blueberries shall be in the size range of 400 count or more per pound.

* 3.2.2 Blueberries, Individually Quick Frozen (IQF). The IQF blueberries shall have been prepared from blueberries meeting the requirements of 3.2.1 and 3.3.1.

3.2.3 Water. Water used for formulation, blanching, and washing shall conform to the National Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.4 Sugar. Sugar shall be white, refined, sucrose, granulated cane or beet, or a combination of both and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.5 Starch, waxy maize, modified. The starch shall be a white, odorless, finely pulverized, modified, waxy maize starch for use in thermoprocessed foods. The modified starch shall demonstrate initial viscosity development in the temperature range of 140° to 170°F and a typical viscosity (be fully hydrated) at common retort temperatures. The starch shall resist breakdown at low pH, under shear stress, and under conditions of cold storage. The starch shall be bland with essentially no cereal or starch taste and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.6 Juice, lemon. Lemon juice shall be prepared from the unfermented juice, obtained from fresh sound mature and thoroughly cleaned fruit of one or more of the high acid varieties of the species Citrus limon (limonia). Such lemon juice may be canned or frozen, single strength or concentrated.

3.2.7 Salt. Salt shall be noniodized, white, refined sodium chloride with or without anticaking agents and shall comply with the purity standards for sodium chloride as described in the Food Chemicals Codex.

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3.3 Preparation and processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

* 3.3.1 Fresh blueberry preparation. The fresh blueberries shall be sorted to remove objectionable material and defective berries. The sorted blueberries shall be washed and thoroughly drained. The drained blueberries shall be handled in a manner to prevent discoloration and shall be used in product preparation or individually quick frozen within 4 hours after draining.

* 3.3.2 Frozen blueberry preparation. The frozen blueberries shall be thawed or tempered only to the degree necessary to accommodate product preparation procedures.

* 3.3.3 Preparation of the dessert. The blueberry dessert shall be formulated and prepared as follows:

Ingredient	Percent by weight
Blueberries	60.0
Water	20.2
Sugar	15.2
Starch, modified 1/	3.0
Juice, lemon, single strength 2/	1.5
Salt 3/	0.1

1/ The total amount of starch in the formula may be adjusted, if necessary, to ensure compliance with the finished product viscosity requirements (see 3.5).

2/ The total amount of lemon juice shall be adjusted as necessary to ensure compliance with the finished product pH requirements.

3/ The total amount of salt shall be adjusted as necessary to ensure compliance with the finished product salt requirements.

a. Approximately 80 percent of the water and the salt, sugar and lemon juice shall be mixed and heated until the sugar is completely dissolved.

b. A thin slurry of the remaining water and the starch shall be prepared and added to the above mixture with continuous agitation.

c. When a hot fill method is to be used (see 3.4.1), the blueberries shall be gradually added to the mixture, and the mixture shall be heated to 180° to 190°F with continuous but gentle agitation.

d. When a thermoprocessing method is to be used (see 3.4.2), the blueberries shall be gradually added to the mixture, and the mixture shall be heated to 140° to 160°F with continuous but gentle agitation.

e. The volume of the final mixture shall be adjusted with water to compensate for evaporation loss during heating and holding.

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f. The cooked product shall be filled into tray pack cans within 1 hour after cooking. The temperature of the prepared product shall be maintained at not less than 190°F until filling into the cans or at not less than 150°F if the cans are to be thermoprocessed after filling and sealing (see 3.4.2).

3.4 Tray pack filling and thermostabilizing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with product such as to conform to the finished product requirements (see 3.5) and to either 3.4.1 or 3.4.2.

3.4.1 Hot fill method.

a. The temperature of the product at the time of filling shall be in the temperature range of 190° to 200°F.

b. Each can shall be hermetically sealed at a product temperature of not less than 180°F so as to ensure compliance with finished product requirements (see 3.5).

c. The cans shall be inverted immediately after sealing, held for 5 minutes, and then rapidly cooled to 100°F or less.

3.4.2 Thermoprocessing method.

a. Immediately after filling, each can shall be hermetically sealed under a vacuum established by a processing authority and specified in the scheduled process so as to ensure compliance with the finished product requirement (see 3.5m).

b. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting at 220°F or below to an internal product temperature of 185° to 195°F. The product shall then be immediately cooled to 100°F or less.

c. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in the retort process within 2 hours after product preparation.

* 3.5 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. The average net weight shall be not less than 106 ounces.

e. No individual can shall contain less than 104 ounces of product.

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f. The salt content shall be not greater than 0.3 percent nor less than 0.1 percent.

g. The blueberries shall not be mushy, hard, tough, or fibrous.

h. The sauce shall have a glossy smooth appearance and shall not be lumpy.

i. There shall be no evidence of syneresis.

j. The pH shall be in the range of 3.2 to 3.8 inclusive.

k. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

l. The viscosity of the sauce shall be not less than 7.0 cm per 10 seconds nor greater than 11.0 cm per 10 seconds when determined by a Bostwick Consistometer (see 4.5.3.5).

m. Filled, sealed, and hot filled or retorted cans shall show evidence of proper vacuum as determined by concavity of the can lid (see 4.5.6).

n. The product shall have texture, flavor, odor, and color characteristic of blueberry desserts.

3.5.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.6 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed, and packaged in establishments meeting the requirements of 21 CFR, Part 110, "Current Good Manufacturing Practice in Manufacturing Processing, Packaging or Holding of Human Food," and the plant sanitation requirements of the appropriate Government inspection agency.

3.7 Federal, Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all the requirements of this specification. The contractor shall ensure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

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4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of inspection and supervision necessary to ensure compliance with the requirements of this specification.

4.3 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, and compliance shall be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, sealing, and packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

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* 4.5.3 Tray pack inspection. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

4.5.3.1 Net weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 1 ounce. If the average net weight is less than 106 ounces or if the net weight of any individual can is less than 104 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

* 4.5.3.2 Product inspection. The sample size shall be as indicated by the double sampling plan specified in table I. The samples shall be selected at random from the lot. The samples shall be opened and inspected for the defects listed in table II.

TABLE I. Double sampling plan for product inspection 1/

Lot size (cans)	Sample size (cans)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0 to 3200	8	-	0	2
	8	16	1	2
3201 to 35000	13	-	0	3
	13	26	3	4

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second samples shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

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TABLE II. Product defects 1/ 2/ 3/ 4/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Texture, flavor, odor, and color not characteristic of blueberry dessert
102	Blueberries hard, fibrous, tough, or mushy
103	Sauce not glossy or smooth
104	Product exhibits syneresis (weeps)
105	Sauce is lumpy
106	Product shows evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched)

1/ The presence of foreign material (for example, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, metal), foreign odor or flavor (for example, burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot (see 3.5.1).

3/ Interior of filled and sealed cans shall be examined visually for coating defects during product examination. Suspected rust spots shall be verified by testing in accordance with 4.5.7. Any spot verified as a rust spot shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Any scratch or fracture that penetrates through the coating of a can shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4/ The product shall be poured into a U.S. Standard No. 8 sieve and the strained liquid shall be retained for viscosity testing (see 4.5.3.5).

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4.5.3.3 pH testing. Three tray packs shall be selected at random from the lot and individually tested for pH in accordance with the applicable chapter for pH determination of the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1. If any pH reading is less than 3.2 or more than 3.8, it shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

* 4.5.3.4 Salt content testing. Three filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot. The tray pack cans shall be individually tested for salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, except that preparation of the samples shall be as follows: The cans shall be opened and the entire contents of each can shall be separately blended in a Waring Blendor or equivalent. The test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result failing to conform to the salt requirement in 3.5 shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

* 4.5.3.5 Viscosity testing. The free liquid collected from each of the cans in the sample selected for product inspection (see 4.5.3.2 and footnote 4/ to table II) shall be strained through a U.S. Standard No. 8 sieve. The strained free liquid shall be individually tested for viscosity as follows (see 6.4).

Instrument: Bostwick Consistometer

Catalog Number: 23270-004	or	Catalog Number: 15-347-50
VWR Scientific Company		Fisher Scientific
P.O. Box 7900		585 Alpha Drive
San Francisco, CA 94120		Pittsburgh, PA 15238

Method:

a. Level the instrument.
b. Bring sauce to 100° ± 1°F in a water bath in a covered container.
c. Stir sauce thoroughly before filling the Bostwick cavity.
d. Scrape sauce evenly across upper edge of cavity.
e. Release sauce and time sauce flow to the nearest 1 second and distance traveled to the nearest 0.1 cm.

Any result failing to conform to the viscosity requirement in 3.5 shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

* 4.5.4 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that the inspection for labeling shall be as specified in 4.5.4.1. In addition, the following defect shall be classified as a major defect.

Evidence of buffing with an abrasive substance (see 5.1.1).

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4.5.4.1 Can label examination. Labels shall be examined for defects in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4) except, for self-adhering labels, the following additional defects shall apply:

Major: Label torn or scratched so as to obliterate any of the markings.

Minor: Air bubbles under label.
Label not properly adhered to can for example, label raised or peeled back from edges or corners.

4.5.4.2 Label adhesive examination. When self-adhering labels are used, the adhesive shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D 3330.

* 4.5.5 Can closure examination. Can closure shall be examined visually and by teardowns in accordance with the can manufacturer's requirement and 21 CFR, Part 113, Subpart D. Any nonconformance based on observation of can seam teardowns or on record of can seam teardowns shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of any involved product.

* 4.5.6 Vacuum examination. Cans shall be allowed to cool to 75° ± 5°F, held for at least 24 hours after sealing, and then examined for vacuum retention. To examine, lay a straight edge in the center of the lid along the length of the tray pack. Both ends of the straight edge shall touch the lid at the inside edge of the double seam. There shall be a visible gap between the straight edge and the lid for the entire distance of the label panel. Using a shorter straight edge, the same procedure shall be used across the width, in the center of the tray pack can. One measurement shall be made when examining a ribbed lid; lay the straight edge between the two center ribs along the length of the can. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in a single shift on a single sealing machine. The sample size shall be 50 cans. Any nonconformance shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

* 4.5.7 Test for rust spots on interior of tray pack cans. Where rust spots are suspected on interior of tray pack cans, the following test shall be performed:

a. Immerse a cotton swab in acetone or methyl ethyl ketone solvent and gently rub suspected spot. Handling of the solvent shall be in strict accordance with the guidelines of the manufacturer's Material Safety Data Sheet (MSDS).

b. If suspected spot immediately disappears, it is not a rust spot.

c. If suspected spot remains, continue gently rubbing with the swab resoaked with solvent, and observe for disappearances or retention of spot. Replenish solvent as necessary.

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d. If spot persists, and all but a very thin interior can coating, or no interior can coating remains, the spot shall be scored as a rust spot. This can be confirmed further by rubbing with a finger. The rust spot will be felt as a slight bump over the substrate.

4.5.8 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Reinforced with other than nonmetallic strapping or tape.
Dimensions of pads not as specified.
Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified.

Minor: Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Arrangement or number of cans not as specified.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. The product shall be preserved in accordance with level A.

* 5.1.1 Level A. One hundred and six ounces of product shall be filled into a tray pack can conforming to MIL-C-44340 and sealed and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.4. The practice of reconditioning tray pack cans by buffing with an abrasive substance shall not be permitted (see 4.5.4). The interior coating of filled and sealed thermoprocessed cans shall be free of rust spots, scratches, or fractures that penetrate through the coating when examined in accordance with 4.5.3.2.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

* 5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L or HSC-L with a HSC full depth cover, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box, with the first two cans placed with the lids together and the next two cans with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). Flute direction of the box liner shall be vertical. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box. Each box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class

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of load specified (see 6.1), except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load with all courses having the same pattern. Boxes may be stacked by interlocking and reversing each tier, or by columnar stacking with paperboard or fiberboard sheets placed between each tier. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box, with the first two cans placed with the lids together and next two cans also with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). Flute direction of the box liner shall be vertical. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of the same material as the box.

* 5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 or 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified, except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load, with all courses having the same pattern. Boxes may be stacked by interlocking and reversing each tier, or by columnar stacking with paperboard or fiberboard sheets placed between each tier. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

* 5.4 Labeling. Each tray pack can shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497 and the following:

- Official establishment number (for example, EST 38) or a three letter code identifying the establishment
- Lot number 1/
- Production shift number 1/
- Retort identification number 1/ 2/
- Retort cook number 1/ 2/

1/ The lot number shall be expressed as a four digit Julian code. The first digit shall indicate the year of production and the next three digits shall indicate the day of the year (Example, March 19, 1990 would be coded as 0078). The Julian code shall represent the day the product was packaged and processed. Sub-lotting (when used) shall be represented by an alpha character immediately following the four digit Julian code.

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Following the four digit Julian code and the alpha character (when used), the other required code information shall be printed in the sequence as listed above.

2/ Required when a retort process is used.

In addition, the name of the product shall be marked, stamping is permitted, on one 1001 by 200 side of the can. The labeling shall be legible when examined as specified in 4.5.4.1 after preparation of product in accordance with heating instructions. Paper labels are not permitted. Cans shall show the following statements:

Tray cans may be heated prior to serving or served at ambient temperature without heating. When heated, the following heating directions shall apply:

TO HEAT IN WATER: Submerge unopened can in boiling water. Simmer gently 35 minutes. Avoid overheating (can shows evidence of bulging).

CAUTION: Use care when opening as pressure may have been generated within the can.

TO HEAT IN OVEN: Either punch several holes in lid of can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place. Place in a 350°F oven for 30 - 40 minutes.

WARNING: Do not place unopened can in oven. This may cause the can to burst.

YIELD: Serves 18 portions of 3/4 cup each.

As an alternate labeling method, a preprinted, self-adhering, 0.002-inch thick, clear polyester label printed with indelible black ink may be used. Self-adhering labels shall be applied after retorting. Pressure-sensitive adhesive shall require no preparation prior to application. Labels shall tack quickly and adhere without curling or breaking. The adhesive shall have a minimum adhesion of 60 ounces per inch width when examined as specified in 4.5.4.2. When self-adhering labels are used, the tray pack cans shall be labeled with the Julian code and a product code prior to retorting.

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, the following precautionary marking in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NOT STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT OR MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE, UNLESS PALLET RACKS ARE USED.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.2).
d. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.2).
e. Level of packing required (see 5.2).
f. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).

6.2 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition instruments regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.3 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.4 Alternative viscosity testing method. The contracting officer may authorize an alternative contractor-recommended method of viscosity testing if the alternative method is approved by the U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center.

* 6.5 Subject term (key word) listing.

Canned foods
Combat field feeding
Operational rations
Shelf stable

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FIGURE 3. Large VLX; Extent inner

6.6 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this specification are marked with asterisks to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review activities:

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

(Project 8940-0716)

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	MIL-B-44256C	1990 December 5

3. DOCUMENT TITLE
Blueberry Dessert, Tray Pack

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial	(2) AUTOVON
U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center	508-651-5221	256-5221
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) Commander, U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center ATTN: STRNC-ES Natick, MA 01760-5014	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

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